

Internet access, making it India's first state with broadband connectivity (defined as 256 kbps and above) in every village.

In keeping with the government's Universal Service Obligation scheme, the Kerala government had started a campaign to connect the unconnected areas of the state last year along with Bharat Sanchar Nigam Ltd (BSNL). Kerala has about 1400 villages and 999 *panchayats*, and this initiative is expected to provide a major boost to the Akshaya scheme—the flagship information, communication and technology (ICT) initiative being undertaken by the state government—to make the state 100 per cent e-literate. As of now, the government claims to have provided broadband connections in all except nine villages.

Sony Ericsson realigns brand

Sony Ericsson is realigning its external visual identity and brand values in order to deliver its vision of becoming the communication entertainment brand globally. The company will adopt the newly announced Sony brand message 'make.believe' in all consumer communication in order to reinforce its entertainment credentials and collaboration with the Sony

JVS Electronics wins national awards

JVS Electronics bagged National Awards for Research and Development and Outstanding Entrepreneurship at a ceremony in New Delhi. The Prime Minister, Dr Manmohan Singh, presented the National Awards to the successful micro, small and medium enterprises (MSME) and to the banks for excellence in MSE/micro lending.

Congratulating the award-winning entrepreneurs, the Prime Minister said that MSMEs have an important role to play in developing the skills of the youth and empowering them to lead a life of dignity and self respect.

ELCINA-Dun & Brandstreet Awards

The ELCINA-Dun & Brandstreet Awards for Excellence in Electronics Hardware Manufacturing and Services for 2008-09 were presented to the winners during the 34th Annual Presentation Ceremony in New Delhi.

The awards were presented by R. Chandrashekhar, secretary, department of IT and the Rakesh Singh, additional secretary, government of India.

Speaking on the occasion, A.G. Rohira, president, ELCINA said, "The

ELCINA-Dun & Brandstreet Awards are regarded highly in the industry as a true measure of excellence. Over the years, the awards have grown in stature adding immense value to the industry, specially on the global scene." He requested that the government should examine the feasibility of reducing transaction costs for the manufacturing sector to enable it to compete globally.

Winners of the ELCINA-D&B Awards are:

Exports. SFO Technologies, AT&S India, Universal Cables, SGS Tekniks Manufacturing

Small & medium scale. Nano Electrotech, Electronic Relays

Quality. Elcotek Electronics, HCL Infosystems, Moser Baer India

Environment management. Vishay Components, AT&S India, Celetronix Power India

R&D. Moser Baer India, Continental Device India

Business excellence. Moser Baer India, Vishay Components

Entrepreneurial excellence.

Kaustuv Ray, chairman, R.P. Infosystems, Sanjeev Sehgal, MD, Samridhi Automations, Amit Gupta, CEO, Three E Innovations

Group. This global campaign will focus on India as one of the key regions and support the launch of Sony Ericsson's new entertainment products

Aino, Satio and Yari.

'make.believe' aligns Sony Ericsson with the Sony Group companies and reflects the coming together of communication and entertainment. Visually, Sony Ericsson will expand the appeal of its globally recognised 'liquid identity' logo by adding seven new colour variations plus a 'liquid energy' flowing from the logo to make it more playful and visually appealing for the digital arena.

Canon rolls out 14 new camera products

Canon India has unveiled new camera and camcorder products to further illustrate its intent and response to fast evolving customer needs in India. This is the second product launch by the company in 2009 for camera products. The announcement



Alok Bharadwaj, senior vice president, Canon India, launching the new camera products